

30-Day Cybersecurity Job Switch Roadmap

Target: SOC Analyst (Tier 1) · 1–2 hrs/day · Beginner-friendly

Prompt A — without context*"Create a 30-day cybersecurity roadmap"*

→ Generic, shallow, one-size-fits-all

VS

Prompt B — with role + context*"You are a senior cybersecurity coach..."*

→ Targeted, practical, expert-level

Week 1 · Days 1–7 · Build the Foundation

DAY	TOPIC	RESOURCE	TIME
1	How the internet works: IP, DNS, HTTP/S	Professor Messer (free YouTube)	60 min
2	OSI Model explained simply	Professor Messer CompTIA A+ series	60 min
3	TCP/IP, key ports & protocols	TryHackMe — Pre-Security Path	90 min
4	Firewall, IDS, IPS, VPN concepts	TryHackMe — Network Fundamentals	60 min
5	Linux basics: navigate, logs, commands	OverTheWire: Bandit (levels 0–5)	90 min
6	Windows: Event Viewer, Registry basics	TryHackMe — Windows Fundamentals	60 min
7	Week 1 review + personal cheat sheet	Your notes + Notion / pen & paper	60 min

Project: Draw your home network diagram. Label every device, IP & protocol. Share on Reddit for feedback.**Week 2 · Days 8–14 · Core Security Concepts**

DAY	TOPIC	RESOURCE	TIME
8	CIA Triad, authentication, authorisation	CompTIA Security+ by Darril Gibson	60 min
9	Malware types: virus, ransomware, spyware	CISA free resources + TryHackMe	60 min
10	Phishing, social engineering, OSINT basics	TryHackMe — Phishing room	90 min
11	Vulnerability vs threat vs risk	NIST glossary + YouTube walkthroughs	60 min
12	Intro to SIEM: what it is, why SOCs use it	IBM QRadar trial / Splunk free tier	90 min
13	Read your first real threat report	Mandiant M-Trends (free PDF)	60 min
14	Week 2 review + mock quiz	ExamCompass.com (free Security+ Qs)	60 min

Project: Analyse a sample phishing email on PhishTool. Document headers, links, payload & response. Portfolio item #1.**Week 3 · Days 15–21 · Hands-On Defence Skills**

DAY	TOPIC	RESOURCE	TIME
15	Set up home lab (VirtualBox + Kali Linux)	David Bombal — Home Lab setup (YouTube)	90 min
16	Run first Nmap scan on your own VM	TryHackMe — Nmap room	60 min
17	Wireshark: capture and read packets	Wireshark official free labs	90 min
18	Analyse Windows Event Logs for threats	TryHackMe — Windows Event Logs room	60 min
19	Splunk basics: ingest logs, run searches	Splunk Fundamentals 1 (free cert)	90 min
20	Simulate brute-force attack, detect in logs	TryHackMe — SOC Level 1 path	90 min
21	Week 3 review + document lab findings	SANS incident report template (free)	60 min

Project: Full incident response on TryHackMe 'Blue' room. Write 1-page report in SOC format. Portfolio item #2.

Week 4 · Days 22–30 · Job Readiness			
DAY	TOPIC	RESOURCE	TIME
22	SOC workflows: triage, escalation, ticketing	SANS SOC Survey + YouTube	60 min
23	Security+ exam domains 1 & 2	Jason Dion Udemy course (~£12)	90 min
24	Security+ exam domains 3, 4 & 5	Jason Dion practice tests	90 min
25	Build your cybersecurity CV + keywords	RezScore.com + LinkedIn job descriptions	60 min
26	Write LinkedIn headline + About section	Review top SOC Analyst profiles	60 min
27	Apply to 5 junior SOC / IT security roles	LinkedIn · CyberSecJobs.com · Indeed	90 min
28	Prep top 10 SOC interview questions	YouTube: SOC Analyst interview questions	90 min
29	Mock interview — record yourself	STAR method for every answer	60 min
30	Portfolio publish + LinkedIn update	GitHub + LinkedIn featured section	60 min
Project: Publish GitHub portfolio: network diagram, phishing analysis, incident report. Pin to LinkedIn. Proof of work.			

Day 30 Outcomes			
Working Home Lab Kali + Splunk running	3 Portfolio Projects GitHub + LinkedIn pinned	Security+ 60% Done Exam-ready in 60 days	5 Active Applications CV + LinkedIn optimised